Eason Gan

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Education

University of California, Berkeley — Berkeley, CA
B.S. Business Administration (Spieker) & B.A. Data Science | GPA: 4.0/4.0 — Expected May 2030

Experience & Leadership

Pickup Games Limited – Sports Networking Platform — February 2025 – Present
Co-Founder and CEO

- Scaled Pickup Games to 25,000+ active users by building a two-sided marketplace connecting players with pickup games and sports venues across Hong Kong, handling game discovery and player matchmaking in one app
- Secured recurring sponsorships and in-kind funding for large-scale events from Red Bull, Li-Ning, Kelme, and Passion24 by developing partnership proposals and sponsorship economics tailored to each brand's audience
- Generated 20M+ views and reached 5M+ unique accounts at near-zero customer acquisition cost through a 100% organic UGC strategy with 15+ creators (2.5M+ combined followers) and no paid advertising spend
- Launched international expansion by conducting due diligence on venue, community, and brand partners across the U.S., Portugal, Brazil, and Australia to establish Pickup Games in new markets beyond Hong Kong

HandsOnExams – EdTech Study Platform — October 2024 – Present
Co-Founder

- Scaled HandsOnExams to 2,000+ students across 5 countries and improved user retention by 45%+ by running 100+ structured user feedback cycles and using engagement data to prioritize product changes and feature releases
- Built an all-in-one exam preparation platform integrating past papers, curated notes, a tutor network, and AI study tools so high school students can revise, practice past exams, and book tutoring support all in one place
- Validated market demand by leading a 4-person team and securing partnerships with education providers and EdTech businesses including Millie Group, opening new distribution channels to reach more high school students

Fine and Rare – Luxury Wine and Spirits Retailer — May 2024 – August 2024
Strategy and Product Consultant

- Pinpointed where a luxury wine and spirits retailer was losing online customers by interviewing stakeholders and customers and reviewing the online purchase journey from initial product discovery through final checkout
- Shaped the product strategy through in-depth market research on luxury wine and spirits e-commerce, benchmarking the retailer's digital experience and conversion funnel against leading competitors in the category
- Projected a 20% lift in online conversion by leading a 6-person team to build a working AI conversational assistant prototype and presenting the business case and projected impact directly to the retailer's senior leadership

Tourvista – AI Travel Recommendation Platform — April 2023 – June 2024
Founder

- Placed top 10 of 800+ inventors and earned the OFEED Gold Medal for European Innovation at the Geneva International Exhibition of Inventions by developing a multimodal AI travel recommendation system for tourists
- Improved recommendation accuracy by 75% over a baseline model by pairing the SOLAR model with a custom reinforcement learning module for personalized Hong Kong travel recommendations for each visitor
- Piloted the system with student organizations and innovation centers across Hong Kong, with 78% of participants rating the personalized recommendations as relevant to their individual interests and planned travel itineraries

Community

Pickup For Good – Youth Sports Nonprofit — March 2025 – Present
Founder

- Raised $9,500+ to expand sports access for underserved youth by organizing monthly runathons, charity sports games, and clinics with partners including Save the Children HK and the Pickup Games community
- Reached 500+ students by scaling Pickup For Good from a single Hong Kong clinic into 10+ recurring clinics across 5 cities in Hong Kong, Mainland China, and Thailand, building a repeatable model for new cities

Skills & Interests

Technical: Python, SQL, React, Excel, PowerPoint, Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG), Reinforcement Learning
Languages: Fluent in English, Mandarin, and Cantonese; Conversational in German and Spanish
Interests: Soccer (Inter Milan Academy), Muay Thai, Surfing, Hiking (Dragon's Back Trail, Lion Rock Peak)